

Art of MUN

The Art of MUN

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1) What is MUN? (By Russel Van Ralte)

Model United Nations can seem intimidating at first. Your stress level as a new participant may perhaps be amplified by the 40+ page booklet you have just been given. But before you give up because you find parli-pro monotonous, take a deep breath and relax. I promise that once you get over this first hump, you won't be disappointed. MUN is fun!!

According to *Best Delegate*, "Model United Nations is an academic simulation of the United Nations where students play the role of delegates from different countries (or organizations) and attempt to solve real-world issues with the policies and perspectives of their assigned country." For example, you may be assigned the country Zimbabwe, and the topic is nuclear disarmament.

There are typically three different types of committees at conferences. These committees are called General Assemblies (GAs), Specialized Agencies (SAs), and Crisis Committees (CRISIS).

In General Assemblies, you speak on behalf of your country when addressing international issues like the environment or access to clean water. The goal of a GA is to work with other nations to create a practical solution to the problem or problems raised in a resolution paper. The GA is the largest body of the Model United Nations circuit, and it involves high levels of depth and intricacy. Those who are the most successful at GAs are able to collaborate with the most prominent committee members, and build a dominant network within their group.

Specialized Agencies are more focused and have smaller committees. Most often, in an SA, you will be representing an individual in an organizing body. SAs operate under the same rules as the General Assembly; the objective is still to write a resolution paper with a solution to the problem. Historical cabinets and corporate panels are very common for Specialized Agencies.

Crisis committees are smaller in size, and they can cover any topic, ranging from politics to science fiction. Crisis committees act in real time, making them fast-paced and interactive. Creativity is key in emergency situations because problems that delegates face early in a committee are frequently different from

those faced later. Therefore, multiple directives are passed throughout the committee. The 'plot' of a committee is changed through behind-the-scenes crisis notes, which are passed by each delegate to the 'game master', known as the crisis director. The goal of a crisis committee is to create a successful crisis arc for your character.

These explanations provide you with a general idea of what you will be doing this year when you travel to conferences with the team. But you might be wondering, *"What is the point?"*

At Queen's, we are a part of the North American circuit for Model UN. Every conference we attend is organized and facilitated by students, so there is no central agency in charge of overseeing Model UN. While having fun and honing your skills should be the ultimate goals of the Model UN delegate, we are also competing as a team against other schools in the circuit. Depending on how well our delegates and our school performs at conferences, Queen's is assigned a place in a North American and international ranking. Behind only McGill and Concordia, we are currently ranked as Canada's third-best university. We chose you to join the team (or re-join the team) because we are confident that you will help us boost our ranking and our school's reputation on the international circuit.

At conferences, we expect you to practise networking and public speaking, but we also encourage you to have fun. It is incredibly rewarding to participate in Model UN.¹ Even though we are all there to compete, the awarding system is ultimately very arbitrary. There will inevitably be times when you are shocked by the awards.² Model UN conferences ultimately boil down to university students awarding university students. Those who are grading you and deciding who gets awards will sometimes be less experienced than you. After two years of Model UN experience, if I have any advice to impart, it would be to not take defeat too seriously.³

¹ I have had the chance to travel to new locations and get to know a lot of really interesting and intelligent people from all over North America during my time spent on the university circuit.

² It has happened at every conference I have been to

³ Despite the fact that I have frequently returned home empty-handed, I am still a brilliant, witty, super-genius polymath.



If you ever have any questions, Jake will help

2) Structure of United Nations

There are four principal organs of the United Nations. This section explains each of their functions.

General Assembly (UNGA)

The General Assembly is the largest of the international bodies. It makes different key decisions for the United Nations. On June 5th, 2023, Dennis Francis (Trinidad & Tobago) was appointed as the President of the 78th session of the General Assembly. His term will start in September. The UNGA is responsible for: 1) Appointing the Secretary General on the recommendation of the Security

Council 2) Electing the non-permanent members of the Security Council and 3) Approving the budget for the United Nations. Bear in mind, every committee where you are representing a country (in any of these organs except UNSC), will be called a GA committee at a conference. The background guide will specify what organ the GA committee belongs to.

Security Council (UNSC)

The Security Council is responsible for international peace and security. It has 15 members (5 permanent and 10 nonpermanent), and each has a single vote. In some cases, the security council can resort to impose sanctions or even impose the use of force to maintain security and peace globally. Security Councils are where the P5 countries can use their veto powers.⁴

At conferences, Security Councils are reserved for only the most experienced delegates. The committees are hardcore and very fast-paced, often with many crisis elements. Awards in Security Council committees are heavily weighted in international rankings.

Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)

The Economic and Social Council is responsible for three dimensions of global development: economic, social and environmental development. According to the ECOSOC website “[the ECOSOC body] is the central platform for fostering debate and innovative thinking, forging consensus on ways forward, and coordinating efforts to achieve internationally agreed goals. It is also responsible for the follow-up to major UN conferences and summits.

International Court of Justice (ICJ)

The ICJ, also known as the World Court, is the main judicial organ of the United Nations. The seat of the ICJ is in The Hague (Netherlands). The international court is composed of 15 judges elected to nine year terms by the UNGA and the UNSC. The ICJ settles legal disputes between countries and gives legal advice to

⁴ In a conference, if someone uses a veto power in other committees, kindly remind them that they aren’t allowed outside of the Security Council.

the other councils. If a state agrees to settle an issue at the International Court of Justice, they are obligated to comply with the Court's decision.

3) Important Terms to Understand

Dais

The Dais is the group of people running the committee. Depending on the size of the committee you are participating in, the dais might consist of one chair, one chair and a vice chair, or one chair and multiple vice chairs.

Points and Motions

Points and motions are the formal language used in committees to ask for things, and, if necessary, appeal them. Points and Motions are tools used by successful delegates to communicate with the chair and other delegates.

Bloc

Think of your bloc as your group of 'allies'. When you first get to conferences, try to seek out the countries or positions that are similar to yours and form a bloc with them. Depending on what type of committee you are in (GA, SA or Crisis) you could be writing resolutions with your bloc, joint crisis notes, or directives. Remember, though, that Model UN is an individual event. You need to make friends and allies with people, but at the end of the weekend, everyone is on his or her own.

Sponsor

A sponsor is a principal author of a resolution or document. The sponsors list is one of the most challenging parts of Model UN. At conferences, being chosen as the sponsor of a paper (particularly in GAs) is paramount to getting awards -- the chair will always cap the number of sponsors on a working paper/draft resolution. The most heated part of any GA or SA committee is the brief discussion a bloc has when they are choosing the sponsors list. I have seen people cry and fight over the sponsors list.

Signatory

A signatory is someone who signs their name to a resolution. Often, those in the bloc who didn't get a sponsor spot will sign on as signatories. A paper must frequently have a certain number of signatories in order to be presented on the dais. It is not always bad to sign off on a resolution as a sig. In fact, signing the resolution can be a wise tactical move if you want to see it on the floor, even for debate. For instance, you can make agreements with opposing countries where you sign someone else's paper in exchange, they sign yours. Signing a resolution does not mean voting in its favour.

Working Paper/ Resolution

A working paper is an unfinished document that outlines potential proposed solutions for the committee issue. Once submitted to the chair by your bloc, this becomes a draft resolution. If voted for by the committee successfully, this will become a resolution.

4) Parliamentary Procedure

First, A heads-up:

Parliamentary Procedures are dense, and there are many rules to follow. You don't need to know all of these procedures immediately. You will slowly pick up all of these rules.

I'd like to acknowledge our previous directors for the extensive information on Motions and Points found in the old Model UN handbook. They've done a really excellent job, and I have copied their information from previous years and used it here.

Parliamentary Procedure

Parliamentary Procedure encompasses the finite set of motions and points that drive the direction of the committee, including guidelines overseeing the topic of debate, whether or not to vote, and what time lunch occurs. Delegates will use “Parli Pro” constantly throughout the committee, and a firm grasp of the procedures is crucial to understanding not only what direction the committee is heading but how to move the committee in the direction you want it to go. The following sections describe commonly used points and motions, and it is important to remember that all actions in a committee (ex., pausing the committee for lunch) must be preceded by a motion or a point (i.e., a motion to suspend debate for lunch until 1:30 p.m.) that the chair of the committee must accept.

Motions

These are the common motions made in a General Assembly Model UN committee, from the most destructive to the least destructive, meaning that the motion most disruptive to the committee will be voted on first, before any other motions. Please note that these are subject to change depending on the conference’s specific rules, and delegates should defer to their chair when there is an issue with procedure. The same parliamentary procedure typically applies to Crisis committees as well. Unless otherwise noted, motions require 50%+1 votes to pass.

Note: Any motion that is bolded should not be done unless absolutely necessary. People will not like you.

1. Adjournment of the Meeting
 - “The delegate of _____ motions to adjourn.”
 - Used to end the committee meeting, at the end of the day, or at the end of the conference
2. Suspension of the Meeting
 - “The delegate of _____ motions to suspend the meeting.”
 - Used to bring about a break in the committee, usually for lunch or a break. This does not permanently end the committee but rather pauses it until the committee reconvenes
- 3. Table the Topic**
 - “The delegate of _____ motions to table the topic.”
 - Requires 2/3rds + 1 vote

- Used to end the current topic being discussed and unset the agenda, reverting to the primary speaker list
 - This is used very rarely, only when there is nothing productive being said about the entire topic. It could be used after all the draft resolutions have been voted on and there is nothing more to say about the topic
4. Enter into Voting Procedure
- “The delegate of _____ motions to enter into the voting procedure on draft resolution ____.”
 - Used to prompt a vote on a particular draft resolution
 - Once in voting procedure, notes cannot be passed, and nobody may enter or leave the committee room
5. Closure of Debate
- “The delegate of _____ motions to close debate.”
 - Used to end a debate period so that the committee may enter into voting procedures.
 - This motion is not always used; it depends on the conference. Some conferences allow the committee to go straight into voting procedures without closing debate first
 - Requires 2/3rds +1 votes to pass
6. Introduction of a Draft Resolution
- “The delegate of _____ motions to introduce Working Paper ____.”
 - Once a working paper is introduced, it becomes a ‘Draft Resolution.
 - This motion, if passed, has the committee do a reading of the aforementioned draft resolution and it then becomes eligible for amendments and can be voted on
7. Introduction of an Amendment
- “The delegate of _____ motions to introduce Amendment ____.”
 - Used to introduce a particular amendment, which can then be debated and voted on
 - This motion, if passed, does not automatically amend a draft resolution, but rather it allows the committee to debate on whether the amendment should happen
- 8. Motion to Change the Default Yield**
- “The delegate of _____ motions to change the default yield time to ____ seconds.”
 - Used to change where time is yielded by default when a delegate on the Speaker’s list does not specifically yield time to the Chair or someone else
9. Set the Agenda
- “The delegate of _____ motions to vote on whether to set the agenda to topic ____.”
 - To set the agenda, choose one of the committee’s topics to focus on
 - This motion does not automatically set the agenda to a topic, but rather, if passed, the committee votes after hearing 2 speakers for and 2 speakers against the setting of the topic. If no speakers volunteer, the motion automatically passes, and the agenda is set
10. Question and Answer Period

- “The delegate of _____ motions for a ___ minute question and answer period, 30 second speaking time*, on draft resolution ____.”
- Used to prompt a period in which certain delegates may answer questions posed to them by other delegates about a specific topic, such as a working paper or draft resolution
- * Depending on the conference/chair, you may not have to specify speaking times and the delegates answering questions may use the time to answer as many or as few questions as they wish
- The time specified only applies to the answers, and questions do not take up time in the question and answer period

11. Extend a caucus

- “The delegate of _____ motions to extend the current caucus by ___ minutes.”
- Used when a caucus has expired but delegates wish to keep discussing the topic
- May also be used to extend an unmoderated caucus
- Note: A caucus can only be extended once, and delegates may not extend an extension

12. End the Moderated Caucus

- “The delegate of _____ motions to end the current moderated caucus.”
- This motion is used during a moderated caucus to have it end before it is supposed to expire
- It is mostly used when there are no delegates volunteering to speak and nothing productive is being said during a moderated caucus

13. Unmoderated Caucus

- “The delegate of _____ motions for a ___ minute unmoderated caucus.”
- Used when delegates wish to move and speak freely in the committee
- There is no need to supply a topic for an unmoderated caucus
- Same procedure applies for a gentleman’s Unmod

14. Moderated Caucus

- “The delegate of _____ motions for a ___ minute moderated caucus, ___ second speaking time, on the topic of _____.”
- Used to direct the committee’s conversation toward a specific topic for a certain amount of time
- When a delegate motions for a Moderated Caucus and it passes, that delegate will be given the option to speak either first or last in the caucus
- The set speaking time must mathematically fit into the full time for the moderated caucus. 45-second speaking times will only fit into caucus periods with multiples of 3

15. Speaking Time

- “The delegate of _____ motions to change the speaking time to ___ seconds.”
- Used to change a speaking time on a primary or secondary speaker list

Voting Procedure Motions

These motions are all related to voting procedures, separate from the debate. Depending on the conference, delegates wishing to motion for these should either do so while motioning to go into voting procedure or once voting procedure has been established. To ascertain which of these options the chair is using, send the dais a note during the debate period. These motions require 50% plus 1 votes to pass, unless otherwise noted.

1. Roll-Call Vote
 - “The delegate of _____ motions for a roll-call vote.”
 - This motion does not require a vote and is automatically accepted
 - The chair will conduct a one-by-one oral vote from each country in alphabetical order as per the Roll-Call attendance
 - Use this sparingly and strategically. It is time-consuming and annoying for everyone involved, and the Chair probably won’t want to do it. Use it if you have a few delegates who say that they’re definitely going to vote with you but who you are suspicious may betray you
2. Divide the Question
 - “The delegate of _____ motions to divide the question, separating clause ____ from all other clauses.”
 - The committee will vote on the separated clauses separately, and only the parts that pass will become a resolution
 - Used when a delegate is okay with certain parts of a draft resolution but do not agree with other clauses
3. **Vote Clause-by-Clause *use sparingly as a last resort**
 - “The delegate of _____ motions to vote clause by clause.”
 - Used to vote on each operative clause of a draft resolution separately, and only the clauses that pass become part of the resolution

Points

The following are all points that can be made at any time during a committee session: Points, unlike motions, are not voted on and are addressed directly by the chair. Points are not used for debate and substantive matters, but rather, for procedural matters in the committee. Points are addressed as they come up. Delegates do not need to wait for the chair to call on them to raise a point, they may simply raise their placard and state the point they are raising.

1. Point of Personal Privilege
 - Used when a delegate believes that something is impeding their participation in debate or personal comfort

- Points of Personal Privilege may interrupt a speaker if they concern the audibility of the speaker
- 2. Point of Order
 - Used when a delegate believes that the rules of the forum are not being observed
 - Points of Order may not address matters under debate
- 3. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry
 - Used when a delegate has a question for the chair about the proceedings
- 4. Right of Reply
 - Used when a delegate feels personally** offended by the words of another delegate
 - ****Personally means that the person themselves, not the nation they are representing, has been attacked.** There is a big difference here, and around 90% of the time right-of-reply points are used incorrectly. If a delegate uses a Right of Reply incorrectly, it's going to make them look really bad in the eyes of the committee. That being said, if you do feel personally attacked by the words of another delegate, then you are free to use the Right of Reply.
 - For example, The Delegate of Canada can not use the right of reply to respond to "Canada is an imperialistic communist state" but may use it to respond to "The Delegate of Canada has an ugly shirt".

Voting

The first thing that all participants in a committee must participate in is a role call, where the Chair takes attendance of all the countries (or, alternatively, the characters) in the committee. At that point, you have to make a choice. You either have to respond to the chair with 'present' or, alternatively, 'present and voting.' Present means that you don't have to vote on all substantive voting decisions, and present and voting mean you do.

Procedural Voting: Mandatory voting for all people (even those who said they were present) on matters that affect the flow of the debate. Motions are procedural.

Substantive Voting: Voting that is dependent on whether you indicated present, or present and voting. Resolution passing is substantive voting.

5) Navigating Positions & What to Research Before a Committee

In Model UN, we often represent cultures and viewpoints that are different from our own. There can be an added level of difficulty if we are meant to defend a country's policies that are considered unpopular in our social sphere. This is

why it is imperative that we put in the effort to understand the roles we play and be conscientious when discussing sensitive topics.

The **first** step to navigating positions is to **research** them correctly. Ask yourself these questions:

- 1) Demographics: What are the country's ethnicities? Religion? Cultures and languages?
- 2) History: Does the participating country have a history of Imperialism and Colonialism? What kinds of Civil and International wars have they fought in? What political and social progression have we seen in recent years?
- 3) Government: Who leads the country? What is the structure of the government? What kind of voting system do they have? What is their economy?
- 4) Relations: What countries are friends?
- 5) Social Ideologies: What kinds of views does a country have? What minorities are in the country, and what support do they have?
- 6) Prominent Challenges: What issues affect the government and people of your country the most? Think human rights, security, health, and education, among others.
- 7) Changing Trajectories: Can you say exactly what your country does (i.e. Human rights violations)? How can we move forward within the scope of committee in respect to the previous six criteria?

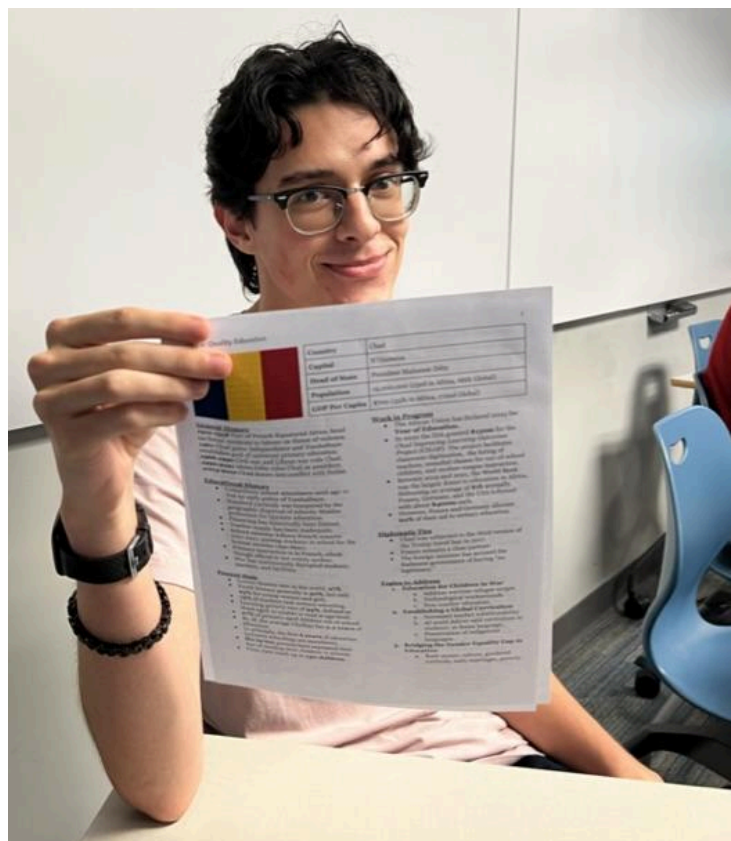
For SAs, these questions apply:

- 1) What demographic does your character fit into?
- 2) What is their history? Where did they grow up? What is their education?
- 3) How and why do you think they are involved in this committee?
- 4) What relationships do they have with other characters on the committee? What is their ideology (if they have one), and why do they think that way?
- 5) What prominent challenges does your character face?

After you have done your research, you will be able to anticipate what other delegates are going to target. Especially when you are representing a country whose beliefs are different or controversial, it is critical that you make sure not to defend points and arguments that some in your committee might find offensive. One effective method often used in committees is to employ vague concepts and non-specific language. Use these sorts of arguments and phrases:

- *“Our policies reflect the will of the people.”*
- *“We are not the same country we were 100 years ago, but not every country will progress at the same rate or in the same way.”*
- *“It's Euro-centric to believe your policies are more correct than others.”*
- *“You cannot infringe on our sovereignty.”*
- *“Our policies are still catching up to our current values.”*

Ultimately, appeal to the root causes of the issues your country faces. Especially if you are representing a country in the global south, research the history of colonialism and racism that may have led to the current challenges. Instead of defending your own country's policies, point out the hypocrisy of Western countries. Deflection is the best defence that still maintains a realistic representation of the country you are playing for.



Research, research, research!

6) MUN Psychology: Different Delegate Types (Jake & Simon)

The MUN circuit is loaded with different “characters,” each with their own virtues, vices, quirks, and qualities. Each of you will likely gravitate towards a specific character archetype. Playing your archetype can be a valuable way to learn, gain experience, and improve your skills as a delegate. Sticking to your archetype, however, can and **will** be detrimental to your performance in MUN (unless you’re a natural MUN God). The best delegates know how to leverage their natural strengths, but can switch gears when needed. **Know how to read the room**, not only amongst your delegates, but also read your chairs and CD’s. The type of delegate you embody will be heavily dependent on socio-environmental factors. A good rule of thumb, be confident, be friendly, be yourself, but don’t be too trusting. That said, here are some common characters you’ll run into on the circuit:

- a) **Binder Nerds:** The delegates who have spent an inordinate amount of time carefully researching their country and the topic at hand. These delegates will pull stats out of their ass and give a perfectly refined definition of any important concepts you may be discussing. Their greatest strength is also their greatest weakness: they cannot BS in a speech. The second their stats are called into question, or the committee is steered away from their information, they fall apart. Refer to the background guides and your own research for speeches; don’t give them the satisfaction of being complimented.
- b) **Power-Delegates (AKA The Georgetown Special):** The name sort of tells you everything you need to know. You may be thinking of images of massive stereotypical Jock types, or the Regina George-esque characters you may have encountered in High School who tormented you, but in reality, they are probably the nerds who got bullied. These delegates don’t rely on facts or charisma to get people to do their bidding; they just intimidate and force delegates to side with them through sheer physical and emotional dominance. Ripping down people’s confidence is their bread and butter, and is also their undoing. When you identify a power delegate, most other delegates have probably clocked them too. Use this to your advantage. Nobody wants to see the villain win, so use populism to your advantage and protect the people from the evil that wishes to harm you for their own good. Basically, just rally support from other delegates who may feel intimidated by the bully. Stay respectful, calm, cool, and collected, and use your natural charisma to ruin the bully’s weekend.

- c) Bill Clinton's (sans Monica): Though I may not agree with his integrity (or lack thereof) as a president, I've gotta give it to Bill for his unparalleled ability to say anything and get away with it. These delegates are the ultimate bullshitters, and crap flows from their mouth like water from a drain. At their best, they can walk into a committee knowing only the title of it, then just go off context clues for their speeches. At their worst, they are still an effective speech giver with a calm demeanour and loads of charisma. Still, their success in committee relies on convincing other delegates of their credibility on the topic, which means they can easily be beaten if you know any facts about the topic which counter their points. Even better is when you can call them out on providing false information to the committee. I like to think that there is a little bit of Clinton in all of us (besides the rampant infidelity), but going full Clinton is never recommended.
- d) The Western Delegate: Literally only there for travel, the parties and socials. Well, either that or they got slotted in a committee they *hate* (shoutout to Crisis deals in GA). *These people kind of suck*. Nobody likes meeting someone in the circuit who doesn't care enough to really be there--it takes the fun out of MUN. That said, there are some unexpected pros to working with the Western deal. Primarily, *they do not care what you do, and you can completely absorb them into your nefarious schemes*. If they like you, they will work with you, at which point you kind of have a de facto ally for the rest of the conference. I (Jake) had 2/6 Western deals in my bloc for NCSC and was practically shoved into running for presentation both times because they liked me. In a crisis, they will give you *all their resources* with little to no repercussions. Use them as often as humanly possible--It's basically like a "free space" in BINGO.

Actual delegates from Western University will walk into your hotel room without invite if presented with the opportunity after a few drinks, follow your entire delegation to a bar, you will leave the bar for food and to get away, then you will see them getting back from their night out at 8am when you are going to the committee breakfast. Lock your doors and steer clear.

- e) The MUNager: Final evolution of a day in the life of corporate workers. Masters at making themselves look like they are doing something while doing nothing at all, these parasites win by making it look like they are the leaders of the bloc, but write nothing themselves. They walk around to each person or group in the bloc and mediate conflicts in clauses to make it

seem like they run the show and are the final authority of the group. To the chairs, it looks like they are the leaders. Problems arise with this approach when it comes to voting on sponsors lists. It might seem to some that they are very important, but since they haven't written anything of substance or importance, their pleas for a spot will likely fall on deaf ears. If you see one, it isn't the biggest deal, just make sure to know your contributions and call them out on their BS. Don't be surprised if they still get a lower award though, some Chairs may buy their deception enough to warrant an honorable mention.

- f) The MUNipulator: Easily the sneakiest and slimiest delegates you will meet on the circuit--issue is, they're *great* people. The MUNipulators are charismatic, outgoing, and know how to command 20+ people without raising their voice, or lifting a finger (shoutout Emma Wong and Anderson Korman). They do not conquer through size, volume (loudness), bullying, bullshit, or pure statistics alone, but a terrifying, chameleon-like capacity to adapt and gain the unwavering trust of the entire committee (at least your bloc). You can spot through the MUNipulator not by characteristics, but by *feeling*. It goes something like this:

Your first unmod, you find a really cool group of people. Maybe two, or even three delegates stand out as stellar. Whipped up into a tornado of infatuation, you fall hard. Working with such wonderful, skilled individuals, you're convinced your bloc is a family that will power through every merger and demolish every Q&A (which the MUNipulator will inevitably get). It's the end of the committee session, and you step into your hotel room. The fog lifts. Denial. You couldn't possibly have let that happen? You're better than that. How could you possibly vote for them for Q&A, they're your competition, not a friend! We were supposed to get through this... together. Anger. You realize they've been pulling the strings the entire time. Your body fills with adrenaline and rage. In this frenzy, comes stage 3. Bargaining. Your mind races 1000 kilometers a second, desperately trying to formulate a strategy to claw from the pits of Tartarus. Stage 4 & 5, depression and acceptance. As you sit down with your fifth bootlegger, staring blankly at the wall as if God himself would etch your escape route, it hits you--you're not going to win, you **can't** beat them.

You return to committee the next morning, but the hop in your step has faltered and the sheen in your eyes dulled. You do your best to enjoy the

rest of the committee, but your ego has taken an unfathomable toll. You chalk it up to a 'skill issue.' You desperately attach yourself to your MUNipulator, attempting to soak every piece of information and strategy from their repertoire to eventually emulate the individual you've come to cherish and respect. It's over.

In all seriousness, this is the most difficult delegate to work around in the circuit. These are the types which are *highly adaptable*, can read people well individually, and in groups, and pander to their egos, emotions, and thoughts. There are three ways to beat the MUNipulator, all are very context contingent and may not always be possible. **1. Divide and conquer.** It's all in the name. If you're unable to command a group with similar efficacy, isolate and manipulate individuals, mould them to suit your ambitions. Works very well in crisis. Particularly useful when you unite the 'Western Delegates,' which is difficult to accomplish across blocs. **Be very careful with this strategy.** American delegates go to conferences weekly or biweekly. They all know one another. If there is trickery afoot, word will get around and you'll be busted, undermining all your hard work. **2. Play the block politics game.** As great as the MUNipular is at directing a group, very rarely can they unite every bloc to their interests. If it is before a merger, attempt to politic and sway blocs in advantageous directions where the MUNipulator will face more conflict, with a lower success rate. If after a merger, there will be several delegates who wish to usurp their power. Use their egos to your advantage, keep them busy tearing one another down while you rise to the top. **3. Sabotage.** MUN can be emotional, and even the best of us lose our patience. If you can find small, discreet ways to sabotage their strategy, take them. A chair seeing an individual absolutely flip and lose their gourd in the middle of committee is a sure fire sign that they will not award, or at least award worse. **Again, be careful**, you don't want to look like a shit disturber, uncooperative, or a poor sport--that too will disqualify you from awards. So be savvy, be discreet, and be a nuisance. Good luck!

7) GA Committees: Written by Russell

The main goal of GA committees, as described in Chapter 1, is to create and pass a resolution that provides solutions to the topic of discussion. GA committees have two main components: in-room (i.e., in the committee room) and out-room.

Speech-making occurs in the room, while networking, resolution writing, and advocating to be a presenter of a working paper all happen behind the scenes (in the outroom).

Some GAs at large conferences are called double delegation GAs. This means that two delegates from the same school make up a single country. Often, Double-deals divide and conquer by utilising their respective strengths and skills. In this model, the delegate best at public speaking gives the speeches, whereas the delegate with the best networking and policy writing skills works outside of the committee room and is tasked with writing a resolution. Double delegate committees can often make up of 130+ people. Your out-room skills are more important than ever.

During the first committee session, many countries will go up to the stage to deliver opening speeches. You should use this time to take notes and scope out the field for potential allies. If you are given the opportunity to speak, use your opening speech to clearly articulate your country's position and make sure it leaves an impression. With time, you'll figure out what strategies work best for you. In the past, Queen's delegates have found success organising their speeches like a very small essay with a strong thesis and pointed solutions. Saying that you would love to collaborate with other nations that are interested in finding a solution to a particular problem is frequently a successful tactic. Making humorous Model UN jokes in between your serious discussions can also be helpful.

Some people believe it is critical to concentrate on the originality and quality of your resolution's clauses when writing a draft, but others point out that as pre-written resolutions proliferate and the writing of resolutions becomes more competitive, the clauses' actual content starts to matter less. Here, you want to strike a balance between writing as much as you can to increase your chances of making the sponsor's list and ensuring that at least one or two of your clauses have a clever, original idea. This is crucial because you want the delegates and dais to ask questions about your clauses during the Q&A sessions and link them

to your paper.⁵ The primary objective in a GA is to position yourself as the centre of attention in the best way possible

Position Papers:

In most GA and SA committees, you will be asked before you go to a conference to write a position paper. This paper, which is often only a page long, is submitted to your chair before the conference begins, and it can affect your ranking as a delegate at the end of a conference. The Position Paper should read like a mission statement, and it should include your research on the subject as well as your plan of action at the conference.

A great place to start your research (beyond what is included in the Background Guide) is the Model UN website. This website will give you the background and language that you should be using as a delegate on the committee.⁶ Depending on what country you are representing, it might also be a good idea to search a country's government website, because it might have written policy on the subject there already. I personally also use Wikipedia, a truly misunderstood website, at the start of my research. Don't cite Wikipedia, though! Instead, go to the links found at the bottom of the page to fact check and find more accurate information.

Once you've finished your research, of course, you'll begin to write the paper. A good position paper is clear and concise. Remember your audience – university students are reading your paper, not academics. You want to seem knowledgeable and intelligent, but success in my opinion, comes from the quality of your research and your solutions, not necessarily flowery language.

To organise your Position Paper, I recommend dividing it into sections. Sometimes (at CONMUN for instance), the conference will give you a model Position Paper that will show you how those running the conference want the

⁵ Use your unique knowledge and skills here. When I am in GAs or SAs, I will always write jargon-crap clauses about Economics (what I am studying). No one will ever debate you about Economics if you write it down, and you can call the whole Economics section of the paper yours.

⁶ If you are entering an ECOSOC committee, go to the ECOSOC website. You can find these links on the UN website.

paper divided. Ask your directors if the conference is giving a mock position paper. Otherwise, I think it's a good idea to format it in the following way:

In the first section, labelled A, provide a quick background on the topic discussed. Include a brief history of the topic, why it is important to discuss it, current perceptions, and why there might be controversy.

In Section B, explain how the issue affects your country. Have opinions on the issue changed, and if so, why? Third, in Section C, write your country's actual stance on the issue now and its goals. Describe how your country has approached the issue at hand on both a local (where fitting) and global level. Here, you should outline proposed solutions to the committee topic. Cite the areas that you would like to see changed and how the international body can approach these issues. Last, write a brief conclusion where you restate your position and include a concluding remark.

Section C is the key to the whole paper, and it should be the largest and most emphatic component. Explain to the Dias why your country is important to the committee and come up with potential unique ideas and solutions that you are bringing to the committee. Of course, this is just one way to format your position paper. It should go without saying that if a committee includes their own format for the position paper, it's a good idea to use that one instead.

Draft Resolutions:

Preambulatory Clauses: Also called Preambles, these clauses serve as introductory statements to a paper. They provide context for the issue at hand, and they also establish the rationale for the approach that the paper takes to solve the problem. Preamble clauses often begin with italicised verbs that typically end in -ing, like "*Recognizing*," "*Emphasising*," and "*Expressing*,"

Operative Clauses: Operative Clauses are the actual meat and potatoes of your bill. These clauses should outline the steps that your paper is taking to achieve your goals; subclauses are used to outline how your body aims to achieve these goals. Begins with an underlined verb in the present tense; the "s" suffix is typically the most common. For example, verbs like implores, creates, and

proposes. Operative clauses are often divided into sections, like economic sections regarding financing.⁷

Amendments:

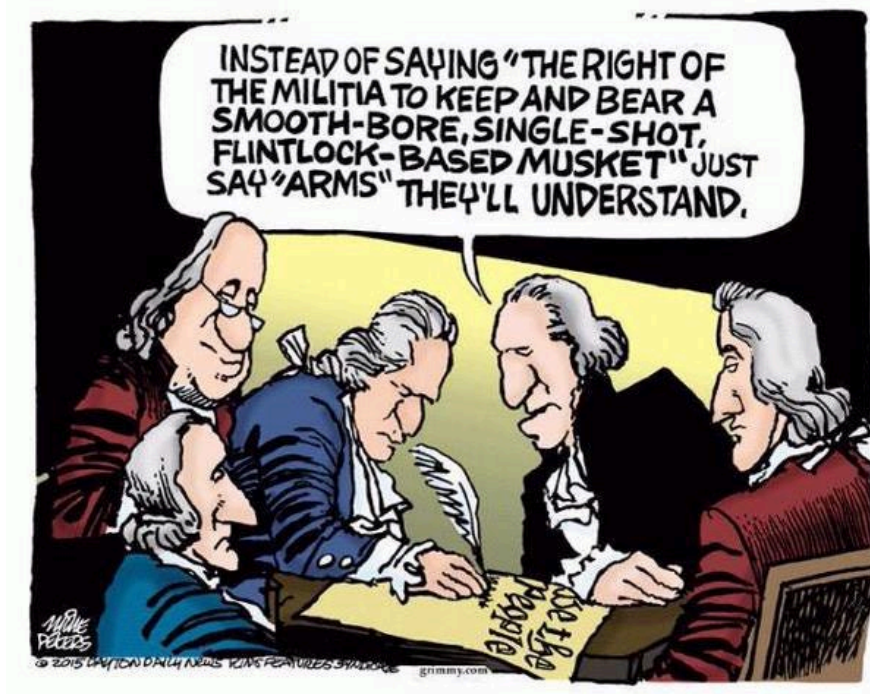
Amendments, or proposed changes to a resolution, are one of the most important parts of a GA committee. Amendments can be considered compromises that delegates make so that the resolution is more favourable to the committee and easier to pass. Successful delegates will use amendments to make resolutions more favourable for their country's or character's position.

Types of proposed amendments:

strike—cutting an entire problematic clause out of a resolution.

Word changes: adjusting the vocabulary of a clause

Clause replacements: removing and changing the entire background of a clause



⁷ Just a quick side note here: it's really important that you don't write clauses before a conference begins. It's considered unsportsmanlike, and if you get caught, you will not be considered for awards (it's also not a great look for our school either).

Friendly Amendment: A proposed change that all sponsors of the paper can agree will make the paper better

Unfriendly Amendment: A proposed change that not all sponsors agree on. When an amendment is considered unfriendly, it is debated in a one speaker for and one speaker against format before it goes up for a vote.

Positioning Yourself to Win (GA):

In the pursuit of awards, the best delegates will try to get on the sponsor's list. It's always a really awkward conversation. I have seen people cry over sponsors' list decisions. It's never fun, unless you are demonic, but there are a few strategies to keep in mind when trying to get on the sponsors' list.

- 1) Explain why your role or country is important for the topic. For instance, if you are representing a country from the Global South, say that your voice is an important one to include on the sponsors list because the voice of your country is not often included in these conversations. **It is important to note that while this can complement your argument, it will not sway the opinion of your bloc.**
- 2) Describe your own personal contribution to the paper. What did you write, and why can other people in your block not effectively defend your clauses?⁸ If your contribution was minimal, it's often a good idea to exaggerate the importance of the clauses you personally wrote. Generally speaking, the best position in a GA is to be in the Q/A section of the sponsor's list as opposed to being relegated to the duty of presenter. It is beneficial for you if you can claim ownership on a section of your paper. For example if you are knowledgeable in Economics, writing the economics section of your paper will lead to little questions and a strong negating position.
- 3) Become a **trusted member of your bloc**. This is more subtle and more discreet, but the best GA delegates are **not power delegates**, but

⁸ In a committee last year, I (Russell) wrote all of the Economic section in an SA Constitutional Committee, and used that as a justification for my involvement in the Q/A section. The other delegate who got Q/A was a delegate who wrote an entire section on the different branches of government. Write about stuff that nobody else knows anything about. Even if it doesn't make sense (like a lot of my econ central bank stuff) -- no one will challenge you, because they don't know or want to talk about the stuff that you are (apparently) an "expert" on.

MUNipulators. If your bloc likes you and trusts you to represent their ideas, they will vote with you--even if it's against their interests. This is **the most important** part. You work from the first moment on Thursday night to make friends in committee, building up to this awkward paisntaking conversation on Saturday afternoon that will make or break your award chances for the weekend. It is absolutely critical that you have allies in your bloc who will vote for you because they like you. This is again where the American delegates have an advantage because they see each other every other weekend. Do not let this intimidate you. It can also be an advantage to you. There are a large number of delegates who do not like each other, who refuse to work together. If you are poltie and easy to work with, they will want to work with you as well. Use this and make friends. These same people will make or break your award chances.

8) Crisis Committees (By Jake & Simon)

Crisis committees are one of the three varieties of MUN committees that can be found on the circuit. I (Jake) personally prefer crises. The main factor that differentiates between Crisis Committees and the others is that you portray a historical or fictional character and get to utilise their individual portfolio powers through clauses in directives and the use of crisis notes. Multiple directives are passed, crisis notes are 'cycled' from 'in-room' (where you're making speeches) to the 'back room' (where Crisis Directors (CDs) and Managers (CMs) are reading your notes & directives, crafting a story, and altering the in-room simulation). The culmination of these efforts is a more dynamic, time-based simulation which forces you to improvise, adapt, and overcome any and all obstacles that the Crisis Manager (or Dungeon Master, if you play DnD) throws your way.

Crisis committees will often follow somewhat predictable patterns due to their story-like nature. The beginning of the committee will almost always be the slowest. The CD's will enter the room and explain the scenario for delegates, and will usually take a few questions.

Usually CD's will throw continuous problems at delegates that they will be expected to resolve. You can expect a committee loop that looks like:

- 1) A problem arises

- 2) Delegates debate how to solve crisis
- 3) (If unsolved) Crisis turns up the pressure
- 4) The CD artificially Increases the stakes
- 5) Timed-crisis (delegates have x time to solve y issue, else things will go downhill *fast*)
- 6) Delegates pass directives or personal directives
- 7) The problem is resolved (hopefully)
- 8) Crisis comes into the room to explain the results, and takes questions to ensure everyone understands what happened
- 9) A new problem arises, return to step 2.

The cycle explained above will continue with delegates slowly building up their resources and abilities until the last stages of the committee, which is when all hell breaks loose. Every crisis committee is different, and every CD works in different ways. Sometimes, CD's have their own ending in mind. They may prefer to take a cookie-cutter approach, delegates affect what happens by choosing the shape of the cookie, but have no choice over the dough. Conversely, some CD's have nothing in mind, and leave the story completely up to the delegates.

At this point, I'm sure I've already lost you. What is a directive? You may ask. Let's take a moment to go through some core definitions.

Directive

A directive is similar to a working paper/resolution, but is uniquely used within a crisis. Instead of having one, large resolution you work on throughout a committee/conference, crisis mandates you pass multiple, smaller directives that dictate committee responses to crisis simulations. If multiple directives pass at once, they will all come into effect with varying repercussions. *Do be aware that directives which contradict clauses in previous directives will be overwritten.*

IE: If you pass a directive which outlaws gambling in the state (how terrible!), but the subsequent directive you pass is about building casinos everywhere, CDs will assume that gambling is, in fact, still legal and the previous directive's clause will be void.

Crisis Update

A crisis update happens occasionally, usually every few note cycles. Essentially, the CDs will culminate the actions of individuals through crisis notes (which will be explained later) and directives to update the committee on how the situation

has evolved, thus changing the playing field. This is when you get the *most information*. Pay close attention during updates. Often, people's faces and reactions during an update will give away which arc is theirs (everyone is always excited to make a crisis update, of course). Use this to gather information, scheme, and potentially throw a wrench in their plans. At the end of a crisis update, the CDs will usually take a few questions. This is a perfect time to not only get clarification on the update at large, but center your arc in the conversation and clarify what resources you have available. Be savvy about this, most people will obviously ask about the portions of the update that concern them, so don't be too obvious.

Crisis Arcs

Every crisis note you send should culminate in a final goal, which is why your whole crisis journey is referred to as a 'crisis arc'--think of it like a character arc in a TV show or Movie. The more Crisis Committees you participate in, the more used to them you'll get and the more you'll be able to develop your own personal crisis style. Creativity is your number one friend in crisis. If you can establish fun, creative ideas and substantiate them through character development, resource building, and (loose) realism, you'll do quite well. But in case you need a bit of extra help, here is a crisis arc model to follow that works.

1. **Resource gathering**--your character will almost always need self-sustainable sources of funding, capital for expansion (wealth, weapons, land, human capital, social capital, etc.), and, most importantly, **information**. Use your first few notes to suss out CDs and find out more about the world around you--but always be moving in *some* direction. You never want to send a note to the backroom *only* to establish worldbuilding. Generally speaking, the more resources you have, the more powerful you become and the more useful you are to others, thus having more leverage in committee. Even though you are just gathering resources, what you are doing should still *be interesting enough to be mentioned in crisis updates*. You may not be doing much, but it should spark the CDs' interest. EG: Starting a chain of businesses--innocuous, but important enough that they'll start 'popping up' around the country, thus being mentioned in crisis updates.
2. **Making waves**--Every now and then you should strive to push committee forward. What I mean is, use the 'issues' you cause in your backroom to steer the crisis situation. Even if the conversation is not centred on

yourself, have it center on the general results of your actions. I cannot overstate how important it is you do this, it is indispensable to awarding. Chairs are looking for people who set the tone in fun, creative ways. If done correctly, this will result in a 'timed crisis' which forces everybody to stop and address whatever mess you've created. This is a *good* thing, use these moments to seize control of the room through strategy, knowledge, and dominance. The size, shape, and intensity of your 'wave' will be contingent on personal preference and direction of your crisis arc. Sometimes, you will want to 'peak' your arc early on, make a big political move, then coast for a bit before you make your last hurrah. Use your best discretion--this will likely come with experience.

3. Making a splash--Some people peaked in high school, but you should be peaking every crisis committee (sometimes twice!). Every note you send should cumulate in a final goal--taking over a disputed region, organizing a coup, or just generally flipping the world upside down. This is where you use ALL your resources and powers you've accrued to go all out. Typically, you want to start putting your final plan in motion during the tail end penultimate (2nd last) committee session. You'll want to climb quickly (this is typically when CDs will look for near point form notes). Make sure you don't move *too* fast, you have to space out your actions enough so you don't cap out early (and thus run out of ideas). By the last two, or three note cycles, your plan should be in full swing, and you should be able to engage in a lot of goofy activities. This is typically the most fun part of the committee. Everyone's plans come together and the whole session becomes a complete, fun mess. In our Lord of the Rings internal last year, I played the Balrog and spent the entire committee digging Vietnam-style rat tunnels in order to drain Mt. Doom, establish Balrog City, and create a militaristic empire. Make your mark on committee, don't be afraid to make it silly--like anything in MUN, it should be **fun**.



Crisis Note (I am so sorry for the length/word vomit of this section)

The crisis note is the crux of crisis, and perhaps the most important thing to understand before your first crisis committee. They are what make crisis dynamic and fun. It's difficult to explain the crisis note. In essence they are your characters' *top secret activities*. Perhaps your character is the head of an intelligence agency in a war committee and you utilize your portfolio powers to stage false flag attacks to draw your side further into the war so you can seize power, or you spy on your political opponents. **You should never reveal your crisis notes or crisis arc to anybody.** (Don't get me wrong, I (Jake) do, and it has mostly worked out for me, but only when I'm absolutely confident in my ability to come out on top or have thoroughly vetted the individuals I'm working with).

When you send a crisis note, it is important that you do not assume the outcome of your request or action. The outcome is ultimately up to your crisis directors and managers. It is also important to not only be specific with your requests, but to justify and substantiate them adequately. A good crisis note is difficult to turn down for these three reasons. Justify. Good crisis arcs always have a little character fluff. In my experience, CDs are generally more willing to give more when they're enjoying reading and writing back to you. Add some character

fluff--but not too much as to not distract from your substantive actions or drown out your plan. Use fun vocabulary, write in unique prose, anything to make you stand out and the CD remember you better. In the tail end of committee (when everything comes together or, more realistically, comes crashing down), this becomes less important. Some CDs will straight up ask you to write in point form. Know when it is time to add character spice, and when it is time to execute your nefarious plans. Substantiate. In my opinion, this is the most important part. No CD will *ever* pass your note if your actions are not substantiated through some kind of resource you've gathered, portfolio power, or the like. You must explain how you have acquired this resource, where you have gone, what your actions were, and indicate your plans moving forward. A good crisis note never contains, "I went on a walk and stumbled into the legendary sword Excalibur! I am now its wielder!" Rather, it takes (often) multiple note cycles of gathering information of the whereabouts of the sword, embarking on your journey, overcoming obstacles, retrieving the sword, and, finally, utilizing it to achieve your ends. With this in mind, it is important to place good contingency plans in place--set traps, have escape routes, use body doubles. Things can go South pretty quickly, make sure you're not caught with your pants down, for lack of better wording. Specificity. Specificity is so important. I like to give CDs the least amount of creative license humanly possible. Why? Because if you're writing well and getting what you want you may become *too* powerful *too* early on in committee. CDs will do what they can to nerf you, if possible, to ensure equity in committee. Of course, a good crisis del is always able to overcome this, work around barriers, and come up with new, creative solutions. General rule of thumb: Keeping it vague means a higher chance of either misinterpretation by the CDs or intentional 'nerfing.' If you know what you want, don't be lazy in asking for it.

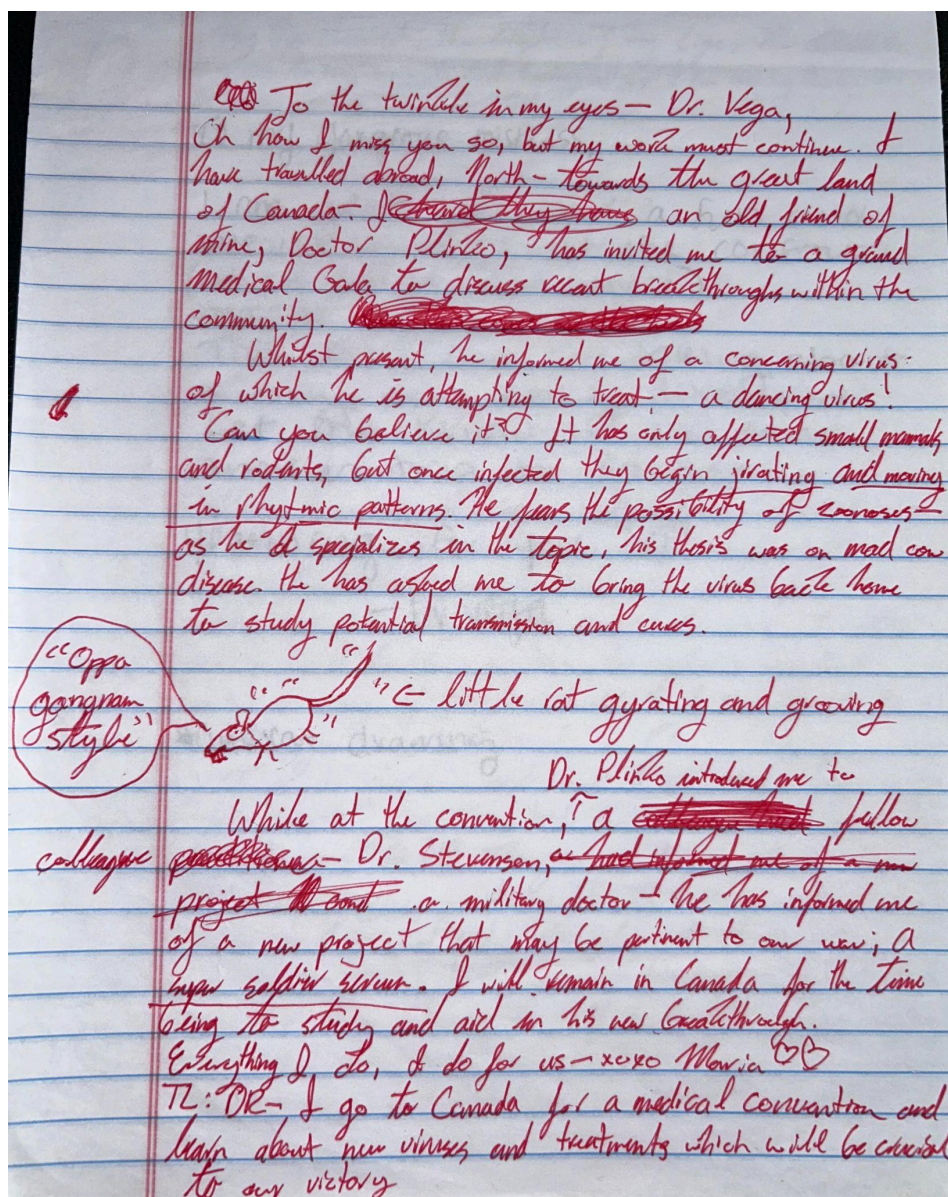
Generally, there are two different styles of writing crisis notes. 1. **The Diary**. You write as yourself, to yourself--like an inner monologue. This is how I learned and how I personally prefer to write, though it is probably less accessible for most. The largest benefit of this format is it exceedingly easy to adhere to the three principles I outlined earlier. If you write well, it is hard for a CD to turn down your note as *you, yourself, are engaging in the action*. You are telling your CD exactly what your character is doing--there is little room for interpretation, or little 'mix ups.' The major cons? 1. Less intuitive to add character fluff in a monologue without it being boring. 2. You lack the natural benefits of the subsequent category, the assistant, in which you can engage in multiple actions in multiple locations (without portfolio powers or resource gathering). 3. If you get

screwed, **you get screwed**. If you are caught in the act, the jig is up. Your character is directly implicated and either major ramifications or the attention of the room will be turned on you (which is not always a bad thing, if you can play your cards right). **2. The Assistant.** You write to a trusted assistant, advisor, friend, sister, or the like. Generally a more accessible format of writing as it is similar to writing a letter. Biggest pro is the ease of access to character fluff and interactions with your CD to humanize/personify your character--at McMUN, I wrote my letters to Dr. Vega, my same-sex lover, and my CD absolutely ate it up. Right from the gate you're also able to delegate tasks to your assistant while engaging in separate activities elsewhere--you remove a logistical barrier to your action. The biggest cons of this style is the forfeit of creative license. CDs will use 'misunderstandings' between you and the assistant to nerf you, tone down your notes, or, at times, outright reject them. I once had a CD turn down my note as my assistant did not agree with my moral actions. CDs are also more willing to let your assistant fail as it has no bearing on your actual status in the crisis committee. A CD killing or imprisoning your character, for example, is far less likely due to the massive ramifications it will have across multiple delegates in that committee. Your assistant goobering up, however, can just be swept under the rug without a second thought.

With all that in mind, let's take a look at what a crisis note looks like (if you can read my god awful handwriting). The following is an example of a crisis note I (Jake) sent on my first cycle, second notepad at McMUN. I think it is a phenomenal example of both what to do and what not to do, as well as outlines my general strategy well.

In this, I combine both styles. I am playing the Minister of Health, Dr. Maria Carvajal, in a Cenepa War committee. I write to my assistant/lover, Dr. Vega. What did I do well? Good character fluff--maybe a bit too much, but not a sin on the first cycle. Use of (crude) images/drawings to convey my point. Vocabulary--the word 'gyrating' specifically came up in the crisis update, and my CDs praised me for it. Underlining key portions of my notes. The use of a TL:DR⁹ (crisis notes get long, always add a TL:DR which summarizes your actions). Appealed to my CDs--at McMUN they're all generally Canadian, of course they're going to love the idea of a 'medical conference' in Canada I'm attending. Finally, I used the portfolio powers of an otherwise boring side character in a war

committee to find something creative and interesting, which I later utilized in my front room to make me stand out and award well. What did I do wrong? The classic mistake of asking too much in a first note cycle--I was never going to get a literal super soldier serum in the first note cycle, it was a hail mary (and not even a creative one at that), but perhaps was worth a shot. If I did, I literally would have



⁹ Stands for "Too long: Didn't Read."

bowled over the entire committee, and our side of the JCC (Joint Crisis Committee, will be explained later) would have won the war almost immediately. Lastly, and perhaps my biggest sin, was having no real idea/direction of where I wanted to take my arc. I find I work best this way, but for many (including myself, at times) this can be a massive detriment.

Finally, understand that crisis notes take practice and time. You will eventually develop your own style and strategy. If in your first mock or internal your notes don't immediately pass, it can be frustrating. Take a deep breath. Talk to your CDs, explain what you're trying to do, and try to gain appropriate, relevant feedback. Every CD is looking for something different. Do not be afraid to ask, ever. At McMUN they threw out half of my crisis arc and I still awarded, primarily (in my opinion) because I pulled them out of the room after almost half of the note cycles to discuss why I was receiving the responses I was receiving, worked with them, and came up with new, creative responses. If you still get shafted, a crashout can be valid--just make sure it's after committee in the solitude of your room (shoutout Thomas and Bianca for being my McMUN rock).

Note Cycle

The note cycle refers to the fashion and timing of which notepads are sent to the backroom, and from the backroom to your in room. It is important to distinguish that crisis notes come in two formats: One pad and Two pad systems. One pad means you write on one, singular notepad, which is handed to the backroom. You cannot begin your next note until the CDs return with your pad with a response to your crisis note. Two pad systems work a little more fluidly. You will have two crisis pads for notes. When you hand in one pad, you can immediately begin writing your next crisis note on your second notepad. The idea in a nutshell--once the CDs have finished responding and returning your first notepad, you immediately hand in your second notepad and continue writing on notepad one. Two pad is more common, and its pacing can feel overwhelming at first. In any case, you will gain better comprehension through experience than through reading this paragraph--so don't fret if you're confused, lost, or intimidated.

The timing of note cycles can be tricky, contextual, and contingent on what is going on in committee (not all of which you will see, as backrooms will affect its trajectory). It is **always** a good idea to clarify with your CDs when the next note cycle will be. I find it helps keep me organized and enables me to prioritize in

room and out room effectively. Stay on the ball, **wear a watch**, and keep your eye on the time **always**.

Joint Private Directives: JPDs

Besides crisis notes and your personal arc, another important aspect of Crisis Committees is joint **private** directives. A joint directive is a request or plan sent to a crisis by two, or more delegates and are be sent alongside/in addition to your crisis note; however, JPDs will *always* need to be co-signed by other delegates as well as yourself. Typically, a JPD will include your characters combining, trading, and aggregating resources or executing some nefarious plan which mutually benefits both parties. **They are typically the only way you will be able to ‘kill’ someone’s character in a committee** (which is always my personal goal, because I’m evil).

That said, JPDs are genuinely your best friend in crisis. Chairs and CDs like to see people working together to push committee forward and find creative solutions. They are easy ways to get brownie points in addition to looping yourself into someone’s crisis arc, thus gaining access to their resources. Doing so correctly “doubles” the notes you’ve sent to backroom (EG: If we are 2 note cycles in, and your JPD partner and yourself have both adequately gathered resources to share, you have essentially added two note cycle’s worth of resource building to your own crisis arc, making you more powerful). A well-written JPD will almost always get a shoutout in a crisis update, which is an easy way to sneakily bridge your in-room with your backroom as the pressure is distributed across multiple characters.

I cannot stress this enough: **keep your joint private directives, private**. People (and by people, I particularly mean American dels in conferences) will stroll about the room in unmod either thinking you are working on a public directive or knowing that you’re scheming and wanting to snoop. Kindly tell them to bug off. A JPD is like a crisis note, you want to keep your arc hidden. You and your partner will likely share some baseline level of information--as always, you have to build trust--but be careful not to overshare so your ally doesn’t turn on you.

The wording of JPDs are incredibly important. Unless otherwise stated CDs will assume your resource sharing is somewhat infinite and reciprocal, meaning your partner can leech off you indefinitely. Particularly in the early

stages of the crisis, ensure your partner does not accrue *too* much power. It is generally in both your best interests to place limits and contingencies on your allyship--though not too many to be viewed as unfriendly (or else you won't really get anything out of it). Always explicitly mention JPDs in your crisis notes when you are utilizing its resources. CDs get a lot of information over the course of a committee so its helpful for them to have a direct point of reference.

I would recommend finding a 'bloc' of 3-4 people who you trust and have vetted to work with throughout the crisis. Touch base with them through your arcs every now and then, working both separately (in pairs) or together (in a group). In addition, it is always helpful to loop in one or two unexpected characters outside your bloc to make yourself seem like 'the diplomat.' General rule of thumb is the more JPDs you send to backroom the better. However, do be aware there is a point of diminishing returns. Eventually, you'll have too many resources to bridge, or too many redundant, overlapping categories, or too many people who have the 'in' on your arc--meaning your chances of getting screwed are high. Use your best discretion and pick people who are fun, you work well with, and have a generally respectable character (in terms of personal values).

Joint Crisis Committees

Joint crisis committees, or JCC's, are crisis committees that occur simultaneously in different rooms. For example, JCC's are often war-time scenarios like the United States vs. Mexico, with delegates in both rooms trying to beat the other room, but also win against each other. For delegates, there won't be a hugely noticeable difference, as each room still has its own awards, so one only needs to win within their own room.

That said, working across rooms (although difficult) can be insanely beneficial. Network, make friends, find out what's going on in your sister room. Often times there will be valuable moments to capitalize upon, and CDs and chairs often look fondly on delegates who are friendly, cooperative, and strive to make (reasonably) large maneuvers. I would recommend not attempting to do something absolutely crazy like splitting the room (making a third committee room). This is logistically messy for crisis staff and the headache that ensues will likely make them a little less fond of you (sorry Mitchell).

Positioning Yourself to Win (Crisis):

In some ways, positioning yourself to win in Crisis is similar to GA. You still want to give good speeches, lead blocs, and have an excellent presence, but on top of that, Crisis committees are all about creativity. The delegates who do best are the ones who show up and write new and creative arcs that aren't just a rehash of any stereotypical army or cult arc. You can still do those arcs, but don't just hire anyone, fill your army with characters or make them a different species. To that effect, try to have a clear end-goal that CDs can pick out. It is way more effective when they see that you achieved a clear goal that you set out to meet.

Similar to GA, making yourself important is critical to your success. While some delegates may be given important positions like Generals, Presidents, or CEOs right off the bat, others are characters who seem almost like an afterthought. How is the Marketing Intern going to become a big deal in the corporate crisis? How you do that is pretty up to you, but the bottom line is clear. Being able to make a side character relevant is far more impressive than being the General of a war committee and staying loosely on top. Your CDs will understand this, and reward you appropriately. Remember, people are often going to go for similar tropes: Communist uprising, Feminist revolve, cult-activity, government takeover. Make your goal unique, different, and representative of your character's goals and *then* find out how to seize power (if that's your schtique) within that framework. In my opinion, the best crisis arcs are built ground-up, rather than top-down.

Where GAs start with an expectation of a reasonable amount of unmods which you know you need to dominate, Crisis committees have a certain degree of variability. Some committees like the freedom of unmods and thus motion for them all the time, others do not. This variability means that you can occasionally take your foot off the gas and coast from time to time. If your bloc finishes its directive and you only have another minute until the next note cycle, take some time to write your note. Crisis committees let you take a few moments to breathe due to the frequency of speaking times.

The most important factor to determining victory in a crisis committee is bridging your backroom with your in-room. Yes, your notes are top secret, but a good arc will give you the opportunity to become the center of attention. Focus on making your notes effective, accessible, and creative/interesting. Make waves as often as you can. Use those moments to steer committee. If it's your crisis arc

being mentioned, there's probably a 'solution' you can come up with that benefits your end goal. Bridge resources you've gathered into directives and JPDs. Sneakily nudge the group's plans towards situations where you can manufacture a 'sudden disaster,' that you can turn around and capitalize on. How you do this is entirely to your discretion, but bonus points are always awarded for creativity and humour. Generally, in crisis, the more you look like a bit of a goober in-room, and the better your vibes are in unmods, and the more fun you are to work with, the better you will do.

9) Specialized Agencies Written By: Matt Weidman

Specialized Agencies (SA) lay somewhere between GAs and Crisis committees. They operate under the same rules that GAs do, however, they are not bodies of the UN. SA committees can be any kind of council, fictional or not. Historical councils are one of the most common types of SAs; for example, you may encounter committees like the business council for Diagon Alley or the War Cabinet of President Roosevelt. It is common for delegates in a specialised agency to play a character rather than a country, but delegates may also portray countries depending on the committee they are in. The beauty of SAs is that they are much smaller than GAs, but larger than a crisis, which allows delegates to have more participation in committee without managing a crisis arc and crisis notes. It's important to note that while SAs seem crisis-like in their topics or themes, SAs do not have crisis notes. Writing and passing a resolution is the goal, the same as in a GA, just with a bit more flare. Specialised Agencies are the happy medium between GAs and Crisis, and are a great place to be if you enjoy independence with a dash of creativity and a dash of formality.

Specialised Agencies allow delegates to speak more frequently, and engage with their committee on a deeper level. These committees require creativity, strong interpersonal skills, and a social battery that can withstand a weekend of schmoozing for support over lunch. As an SA delegate, it is still important to make memorable and meaningful speeches - however, likeability, humour, and the committee's perception of you play an important role in determining how your conference will go. In a smaller committee like an SA it is important to be friendly and approachable, and it should be your goal to make yourself the delegate that everyone wants to work with. In my experience, small things like filling other delegates cups with water, complementing people's appearances, being energetic when other delegates are tired, and generally being a friendly and

approachable person can assist you in generating the goodwill needed to ensure your clauses and/or resolutions are passed. Although it may be tempting to be overtly dominant, don't forget to look around the room and understand what the vibes are and how people may react to your speech. Don't be afraid to compromise if you have to, and despite your outwardly friendly appearance, DO NOT FORGET that your goal is to ensure your clauses and/or resolutions are passed at the end of committee. To put it simply: don't be afraid to MUNipulate other delegates to get what you want, but be sure to do it tactfully and in a way that doesn't expose you to blowback from other delegates in the committee. An SA committee is just as much about managing the perceptions of other delegates as it is about making excellent speeches and drafting creative and genius clauses to address the topic the committee is discussing.

For more information on SA committee procedure, see the above sections in Parliamentary Procedure and General Assemblies. Although the general rules and procedures are the same for GA and SA committees, always be sure to check the rules of procedure (ROPS) of the committee you are in .

Your Gruntled MUNcle,
Matt

10) Conclusion

Thank you for taking the time to read this enormous document. We do hope it's conducive to your success in MUN. Particularly for delegates who have never participated in MUN, this is going to feel overwhelming, and maybe not worth the time. I know I, as well as most of my cohort, threw Art of MUN to the side after the first few meetings--experience will always trump pure rote memorization, but this will always be a resource available for your reference. You'll gather this over the course of the term to become the outstanding delegate we know you can be.

Always remember **you were chosen for a reason**. Each of us determined in your interview that *you had the X factor*. Each of you were fun, creative, and, most importantly, assessed to be *a good human being*. These are things that cannot be taught. If you don't feel like your public speaking is 'up to snuff,' we'll get you to where you need to be. All we ask of you is to show up Monday's, give it your all, and (importantly) come to the Mansion for some team bonding after.

Yes, we will eat up your Monday night and your occasional weekend. That said, MUN is what you make of it--you get out what you put in. The more you invest in your personal development on the team, the better you will do.

Welcome to the MUN family--we're all friends, and will always have your back. If you need anything whatsoever, the MUN team has you covered. Never be afraid to reach out to us, the extendeds, or anybody on the team. The fundamental reason we all join clubs is to make friends and (maybe) develop a few skills. Take advantage of this opportunity. We can all attest, it has changed the entire trajectory of our university experience.

Good luck out there!

**Your 2025-2026 Directorate
Jake, Talitha, Eden & Tristan**



QIAA Co-President Simon Paterson knows how to kill it as a delegate AND have fun